

RESEARCH PROBLEM



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INTRODUCTION

- **A Research problem is a question that a researcher wants to answer or a problem that a researcher wants to solve.**

- **A research problem is an issues or a concern that an investigator / researcher presents and justifies in a research study.**



WHAT SHOULD BE HAPPENING

**THE PROBLEM
STATEMENT**

WHAT IS ACTUALLY HAPPENING

- **Identification and formulation of a research problem is the first step of the research process.**
- **It is the most challenging & difficult phase of the research process.**



Selecting a Research Problem



- **Selection of a research problem depends on several factors such as researcher's knowledge, skills, interest, expertise, motivation & creativity with respect to the subject chosen.**

- **A good research studies needs a lots of time for selection of research problem.**
- **Initially every researcher faces a predicament of identifying, selecting and formulating a good research problem.**

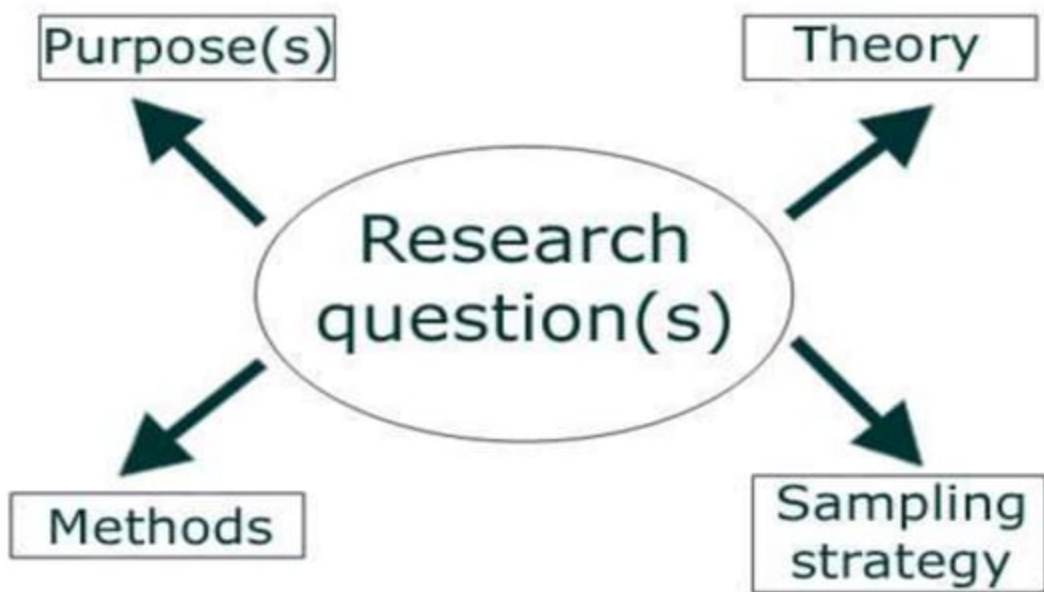
DEFINITION

- **“ A situation for which we have no ready & successful response by instinct or by previous acquired habit. We must find out what to do”, i.e. the solution can be found out only after an investigation.**

R.S. Woodworth.

- **In others words, a research problem is an area of concern where there is a gap in the knowledge base needed for professional practices.**

- **A research problem and problem statement are frequently used as synonyms.**
- **However there are a lot of difference between them.**



Robson (2000)

COMPONENTS OF A RESEARCH PROBLEM

- **A research problem has 6 components.**
- **They are as follows...**

- **1. Relevance of the study.**
- **2. Title of the study.**
- **3. Operational definitions of the variables.**
- **4. Objectives of the study.**
- **5. Delimitations of the study.**
- **6. Scope & limitations of the study.**

IDENTIFICATION OF RESEARCH PROBLEM

- Identification of the research problem is the first step.
- Generally a broad area is selected and then it is delimited or narrowed down to a specific one sentence statement of the problem.

SOURCES OF RESEARCH

PROBLEM

- The common sources of research problem are as follows.
- 1. Personal experience.
- 2. Practical experience.
- 3. critical appraisal of literature.

- **4. Previous research.**
- **5. existing theories.**
- **6. Social issues.**
- **7. Brainstorming.**
- **8. Intuition.**
- **9. Folklores.**
- **10. Exposure to field situation.**
- **11. Consultation with experts.**

PERSONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Day to day experience of the researcher serves as a good source of ideas to formulate research problem.**
- **Eg.,**

PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE

- **Clinical experience provides nurses ample opportunities for problem identification.**
- **This serves as a source for identifying research problems.**

CRITICAL APPRAISAL OF **LITERATURE**

- **When one looks at books, articles, summaries of clinical issues relating to the subject of our interest, pertinent questions may arise.**

- These may strike the reader's mind by stimulating imagination and directly the additional research needed.



PREVIOUS RESEARCH

- **A body of knowledge is developed on a sound research finding.**
- **Usually at the end of the research problems are suggested based on the shortcoming of the previous research, these could be investigated.**

Research Gap(s)



Research Problem or Question(s)



Research Aim



Research Objectives or Hypotheses

EXISTING THEORIES

- **Research is a process of theory development and theory testing.**

- **If an existing theory is used in developing a researchable problem, a specific statement from theory must be isolated.**
- **Generally a part or parts of a theory are subjected to testing in a clinical situation.**

- **The testing of a theory is needed therefore they serve as a good source of research problem.**

SOCIAL ISSUES

- **Sometimes issues of global contemporary or political issues of relevance are suggested.**
- **A idea for a research may stem from a familiarity with social concerns or controversial social issues.**

BRAINSTORMING

- **Brainstorming sessions are good techniques to find new research questions.**

- **Brainstorming refers to intensified discussions among interested people of the profession in order to find more ideas to formulate a good research problem.**

INTUITION

- **Intuitions' are considered good sources of knowledge as well as sources to find new research problems.**

- **It is believed that reflective mind is a good source of ideas, which may be used to find out new and good research problems.**

FOLKLORES

- **Common beliefs could be right or wrong.**
- **E.g., Studying just before examination decrease the score. A researcher can conduct a study to test this.**

EXPOSURE TO FIELD **SITUATIONS**

- **During field exposure researchers get a variety of experiences which may provide plenty of ideas to formulate research problems.**

CONSULTATIONS WITH

EXPERTS

- **Experts are believed to have sound experience of their respective field, which may suggest a significant problem to be studied.**

- **In addition experts may help in finding a current problem of discipline to be solved which may serve as a basis for formulation of research problem.**

THANK YOU

